

REPORT CLASSIFICATION

Classification Type	Full Form Analysis
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DATE / TIME

Date of Occurrence	2018-09
Local Time Of Day	0601-1200

PLACE

Locale Reference	Airport
Locale	ZZZ.Airport
State	US
Altitude - AGL	0

ENVIRONMENT

Flight Conditions	VMC
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AIRCRAFT / EQUIPMENT X

Aircraft Operator	Air Carrier
Make Model Name	A319
Crew Size	2
Operating Under FAR Part	Part 121
Mission	Passenger
Flight Phase	Taxi

AIRCRAFT / EQUIPMENT Y

Aircraft Operator	Air Carrier
Make Model Name	B737 Undifferentiated or Other Model
Crew Size	2
Operating Under FAR Part	Part 121
Mission	Passenger
Flight Phase	Taxi

COMPONENT 1

Aircraft Reference	X
Aircraft Component	Winglet

COMPONENT 2

Aircraft Reference	Y
Aircraft Component	Fuselage Tail Cone

PERSON 1

Aircraft Reference	X
Location In Aircraft	Flight Deck
Reporter Organization	Air Carrier
Function - Flight Crew	Captain
Function - Flight Crew	Pilot Flying
Qualification - Flight Crew	Air Transport Pilot (ATP)
Qualification - Flight Crew	Multiengine
Qualification - Flight Crew	Instrument
ASRS Report Number	1579491
Human Factors	Communication Breakdown
Human Factors	Situational Awareness
Communication Breakdown - Party1	Flight Crew
Communication Breakdown - Party2	Flight Crew

PERSON 2

Aircraft Reference	X
Location In Aircraft	Flight Deck
Reporter Organization	Air Carrier
Function - Flight Crew	First Officer
Function - Flight Crew	Pilot Not Flying
Experience - Flight Crew Total	237.90 hrs
Experience - Flight Crew Type	237.90 hrs
ASRS Report Number	1579493
Human Factors	Communication Breakdown
Communication Breakdown - Party1	Flight Crew
Communication Breakdown - Party2	Flight Crew

PERSON 3

Aircraft Reference	Y
Location In Aircraft	Flight Deck
Reporter Organization	Air Carrier
Function - Flight Crew	Captain
Function - Flight Crew	Pilot Flying
Qualification - Flight Crew	Air Transport Pilot (ATP)
Qualification - Flight Crew	Multiengine
Qualification - Flight Crew	Instrument
Experience - Flight Crew Type	2472 hrs
ASRS Report Number	1579497

PERSON 4

Aircraft Reference	Y
Location In Aircraft	Flight Deck
Reporter Organization	Air Carrier
Function - Flight Crew	First Officer
Function - Flight Crew	Pilot Not Flying
Qualification - Flight Crew	Air Transport Pilot (ATP)
Qualification - Flight Crew	Multiengine
Qualification - Flight Crew	Instrument
Experience - Flight Crew Type	1791 hrs
ASRS Report Number	1579485

EVENTS

Anomaly	Conflict - Ground Conflict, Less Severe
Anomaly	Ground Event / Encounter - Aircraft
Detector - Person	Flight Crew
Miss Distance - Horizontal	0
Miss Distance - Vertical	0
When Detected	Taxi
Result - General	Maintenance Action

ASSESSMENTS

Contributing Factors / Situations	Airport
Contributing Factors / Situations	Human Factors
Contributing Factors / Situations	Procedure
Primary Problem	Human Factors

NARRATIVE 1

We were cleared to gate. As we entered, there was a B737 waiting to park [two gates over]. I taxied behind the B737 and got close to its tail to clear the taxiway behind us. While we were stopped, waiting for the B737 to move forward, the Ramp Controller asked if we could make it around the B737 to our gate. I thought we could; the First Officer did not and advocated that very clearly to me.

I started moving in a tight right turn then stopped because I wasn't sure that I would safely clear the B737's tail. My stopping caused our nose wheel to straighten as the aircraft moved forward a few more inches. At that point, I really thought we would clear the B737's tail and inched forward. I felt a small bump and realized I had misjudged the distance and hit the B737's APU exhaust with our left wing tip.

A short time later, the B737 moved forward and I could see what looked like a dent in its APU exhaust. The B737 proceeded to [its] gate and I decided that the best thing would be for us to proceed to our gate.

Just after we set the parking brake, and turned the seat belt signs off, the Purser called to let us know that one of the passengers had told her that we might have bumped the B737's tail.

After our post-flight flows, and the Parking Checklist was complete, I made a maintenance entry then contacted the [Chief Pilot].

This was completely my fault. It was wrong of me to ignore the First Officer and to even attempt this maneuver, especially at night. My main concern was not getting to our gate but making sure that I had cleared [the] taxiway so we wouldn't be blocking other traffic. That, obviously, should not have been my first concern.

NARRATIVE 2

We landed on Runway XXR and taxied to gate. As we crossed Runway XYL on taxiway, we got behind a B767 under tow and followed him down. At this point, things were getting busy and there was going to be traffic congestion getting into our gate. I contacted Ramp Control letting them know we were approaching the gate.

The controller instructed us to proceed in via the line to gate. As we neared the line, we could see a 737 stopped short of [a] gate [that was two gates over]. Captain pulled in behind the 737, came to a stop and set the parking brake. I could see that taxi lane was open and that the 737 wasn't moving into his gate. Ramp Control asked us if we could make the right turn and join taxi lane to get around the 737 and into our gate. I felt that there was no way our wing would clear the tail of the 737 and stated that to the captain, I couldn't however see the left wingtip and saw that [Captain] was watching it closely out of his window. [Captain] was respectful and said "I pulled up close to him so as to not block taxiway and actually I think we can make it". I hadn't answered the Ground Controller yet and he again called us and asked if we could make it around the company traffic. The controller instructed us to join the Charlie line into our gate.

As Captain released the parking brake and steered the tiller to the right, we began to make our turn, and as we were nearly perpendicular to the 737 we both felt a "bump"; it was evident that we had made contact with the 737. Captain stopped the airplane immediately and set the parking brake. Once the 737 began moving into [its] gate, we continued our taxi into [our gate], shut the engines down, performed the Parking Checklist and deplaned our passengers normally. We immediately notified Maintenance and the Captain called the Chief Pilot.

NARRATIVE 3

After landing our scheduled gate was occupied and we were sent to the penalty box. A new gate was assigned so we coordinated with ground and taxied to the north port. We entered the north port on the B line. As we approached the gate they were repositioning both jet bridges. I turned approximately 45 degrees toward the gate, positioning for a better view. About 20 feet prior to the pushback release point the wing walker to the right of the nose held up crossed lighted wands. I stopped and set the parking brake. A few moments later while stopped with the parking brake set we felt an unusual aircraft movement. My first officer and I discussed this as possibly being jet blast from behind or maybe nose strut compression from the extended position. Neither of us thought it was an impact of any kind. Shortly following the unusual aircraft movement (not more than two minutes, neither of us recalls a better time estimate) the APU flamed out and we lost electrics. I quickly transferred power back onto the engine generators and restarted the APU. The APU started normally. I transferred electrical power to the APU generator with normal indications. Sometime during all this, ramp asked us to pull forward a bit. I complied but stopped short of the vehicle road and reset the parking brake until the marshaller was ready and activated electronic parking guidance. Normal/uneventful parking was accomplished. About 45 minutes later while getting our next plane ready I received a cell phone call from [Flight Operations] asking if I knew our previous plane had been hit by a taxiing Airbus. I told them I did not know we had been hit but relayed the above information to him. Obviously, with the new information the sequence of events is now very clear. [Flight Operations] said I was "in the clear" as far as the incident since I was stopped with the parking brake set and did not need to take any additional action.

NARRATIVE 4

After landing we proceeded to taxi into the terminal and was informed by ramp control that our gate was occupied. we then informed ground control that we needed to go to the penalty box and wait for gate to open up. We sat in the penalty box for about 5 min and was informed that our new gate was now [assigned] by ramp

control who told us to proceed to the north port. I asked for clarification that our new gate was in fact open. I was told again by ramp control that we should proceed to the north port and call when we got there. I got a clearance from ground to proceed as directed and we taxied there without incident. When we got to the gate they were still in the process of moving both jetways to accommodate our aircraft. We waited for approximately 5-10 min. with the parking brake set while we waited, during our wait we experienced a bump and discussed it with the captain and came to the conclusion that it was probably jet blast from another aircraft. Shortly after our APU shutdown and we had to transfer electrical power back to the engine generators. The ground personnel finished and we taxied into the gate via electronic guidance. It was not until after we switched aircraft and getting ready for our next flight did we find out what had happened.

SYNOPSIS

Two air carrier flight crew reported aircraft to aircraft contact was made on the airport ramp.

